

INVESTOVILLA PIPELINE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM FOR ENTREPRENEURS

Building Africa's Next Generation of Investor-Ready Ventures

pipeline.amstevehouse.com



About the Program

Are you building a startup for Africa?

Are you preparing to raise capital—or already in the middle of a fundraise?

Do you need experienced guidance to help you avoid costly mistakes, sharpen your fundraising strategy, and engage investors with greater confidence?

If that sounds like you, welcome to the InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program for Entrepreneurs (IPDPE).

The InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program for Entrepreneurs is a practical investment-readiness and fundraising support program for founders who are serious about building ventures that can attract capital and engage investors from a position of strength.

This is not another startup training program.

It is a hands-on experience designed to help founders understand what investors look for, strengthen the fundamentals of their ventures, and develop a more disciplined approach to fundraising.

Through a combination of venture design, fundraising strategy, mentorship, peer learning, practical assignments, and real-world fundraising activities, participants receive structured support throughout their fundraising journey while enjoying access to an unrivalled proprietary investor-readiness diagnostic that generates a founder-facing and investor-facing report.

The program is designed to help founders:

- Increase fundraising readiness
- Improve investor engagement

- Avoid common fundraising mistakes
- Develop stronger fundraising strategies
- Build investor confidence
- Improve their chances of securing capital

The goal is straightforward.

To help founders become more investable, more prepared, and more effective in their interactions with investors.

Why This Program Exists

Raising capital in Africa is not getting easier.

Investors are writing fewer cheques. Competition for capital is increasing. Due diligence is becoming more rigorous, and founders are expected to demonstrate stronger fundamentals much earlier than before.

Yet many promising ventures are still approaching fundraising without the preparation needed to compete effectively.

The challenge is not always the quality of the idea.

More often, it is a readiness problem.

Founders begin fundraising before their business model is fully developed. Their investor materials are incomplete. Their capital strategy is unclear. They spend months chasing conversations that were unlikely to convert in the first place.

For African founders, the challenge is often compounded by a market that frequently prices perceived risk more heavily than actual risk. The result is a higher cost of capital, fewer opportunities, and a fundraising environment that can feel unnecessarily difficult to navigate.

We believe fundraising starts long before the first investor meeting.

It starts with a venture that can withstand scrutiny.

A clear understanding of the market.

A compelling investment case.

And a strategy grounded in reality.

The InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program for Entrepreneurs was created to help founders bridge that gap.

Not by promising funding.

Not by teaching fundraising theory in isolation.

But by helping founders build investor-ready ventures, engage investors more effectively, and approach fundraising with greater clarity, structure, and confidence.

About InvestoVilla

InvestoVilla is a founder-investor platform being developed by AM-Steve House to improve how promising ventures connect with investors across Africa and beyond.

The platform is being built as a marketplace where founders can discover capital opportunities, engage investors, and access resources that improve fundraising outcomes. The platform provides market intelligence, access to hundreds of thousand of investors and financiers, business development opportunities and fundraising.

The Pipeline Development Program is being developed ahead of the InvestoVilla Funds Platform as well as InvestoVilla Syndicate programs to be launched later in the year. This Pipeline Development program serves as the first step in that journey.

It is where founders get unparalleled preparation.

It is where investment readiness is built.

It is where the next generation of African unicorn ventures begins.

The program will be led by our Managing Partner, Ugwumsinachi Okorie – [read more here](#)ⁱ

InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™

Every participating venture undergoes the InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™ (IVBA), an independent evaluation of investor readiness across key areas including team, market, product, traction, financial preparedness, and fundraising readiness.

Founders receive an InvestoVilla Venture Backability Report™ (IVBR)—a practical tool for improving their ventures and a structured report that can support more informed conversations with investors.

Each participating startup will be assessed across:

- Team [Capability, commitment, governance]
- Product [Solution fit, differentiation]
- Market [Opportunity, customer understanding]
- Traction [Validation, growth signals]
- Financials [Unit economics, planning]
- Fundraising Readiness [Materials, strategy, readiness]

Participants receive an overall Venture Readiness Score:

- Emerging – Early foundations in place, significant development required.
- Investable – Strong fundamentals with clear opportunities for improvement.
- Investor-Ready – Well-positioned for active investor engagement.
- Syndicate-Ready – Highly prepared ventures suitable for curated investor introductions and syndicate opportunities.

The assessment helps founders understand where they stand today and what needs to improve before approaching investors.

Who Should Apply?

The program is designed for founders in Africa and globally building ventures for African markets.

You should apply if:

- You are building a venture focused on African markets
- You are an African founder, an African in the diaspora building for Africa, or a non-African founder building solutions for African markets
- Your company is incorporated in Africa or plans to establish African incorporation
- You are currently raising or expect to raise between \$20,000 and \$1 million in equity or debt financing
- You are between Pre-Seed and Series A stage
- You want structured guidance before, during, or alongside your fundraising journey

Bootstrapped ventures raising beyond Series A may also be considered on a case-by-case basis.

Program Structure

Venture Readiness Clinic*		
Topics	Sessions	Deliverables
Business Model Design Product-Market Fit Venture Backability Assessment (VBA)	Pattern Recognition (Froebelian learning)	Venture Backability Report
	Group Facilitation	Submission to 2 actively deploying funds (qualified ventures)
	Executive Peer Board	Review of Pitch Deck
	One-on-One Consultation	Funding Strategy Memo
	Venture Design Workshop	Approved Lean Canvas
Rationale: you can't tell a good story if you don't yet have a story. Qualified founders will submit funding requests to selected funds actively deploying capital through our pre-arranged deal scouting arrangement. We have no control on the outcome. Founders will leverage the feedback at the accelerator or leverage the accelerator to negotiate and close the deal as their capstone projects.		
* Duration: the clinic will run in 2 class options of either 2 weeks (for intensive class) and 4 weeks (for the regular class).		
The Fundraising Accelerator		
Startup Funding Fundamentals & Venture Finance Landscape Capital Structure Planning	Flipped Classroom Action Learning Group Coaching	Capital Raise Strategy and Fundraising Plan Fundraising Data Room Investor Target List ¹

¹ Investor Pipeline Mapping

As a Pipeline Development Program, founders will leave with:

- Investor Universe Mapping

Fundraising Strategy Design Fundraising Process Management Investors Psychology and Targeting Due Diligence Preparation Negotiation Skills and Readiness	Capstone & Fundraising Hackathon Mentorship Real-Time Feedback and Reviews Peer Accountability Structures	Investor Outreach Campaign Fundraising CRM Investor Engagement Support
Rationale/Design: Learning by doing, not just theory (action-learning). The Fundraising Accelerator is where preparation meets the market. Participants launch or strengthen real fundraising efforts while receiving structured guidance, mentorship, accountability, and practical support. Drawing on feedback from fund submissions during the clinic phase, where available, and their fundraising strategy, founders will execute an active fundraising process under expert guidance. Progress is supported through fortnightly reviews and check-ins. Top-performing participants may be introduced to participating investors, the InvestoVilla syndicate program and Funds Platform, or selected allied investment partners. Duration: The standard accelerator runs for 12 weeks. An intensive version may be offered for a pre-selected founder with peculiar		

Why IPDPE?

There other investor match-making programs but IPDPE is different because:

- ❖ Access to tools and validation that accelerate your journey and catalyze result
- ❖ We don't just teach fundraising. We help founders become investor-ready
- ❖ Move from learning, to preparation, to execution
- ❖ Practical fundraising support without giving up equity
- ❖ Strengthen fundraising readiness, improve investor engagement, and avoid costly mistakes.
- ❖ Improve the likelihood of productive fundraising outcomes
- ❖ Don't just raise, raise well from a position of strength
- ❖ Exit the program with better and more investable venture and market clarity
- ❖ Build real network, market strategy, strategic partnership and position for exponential performance

Fees & Participation

The Venture Readiness Clinic and Fundraising Accelerator are offered free for selected at no cost to selected founders. However, accepted participants are required to make a Founder Commitment Contribution of **US\$299**.

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- Investor Prioritization Matrix
 - Investor Outreach Plan

This contribution covers participation in the InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™, ordinarily priced at **US\$499**, and serves as a commitment mechanism to help ensure a high-quality founder experience and a strong venture pipeline throughout the program.

To ensure that promising founders are not excluded for financial reasons, applicants who apply and complete onboarding on or before **June 30, 2026** may request need-based support, reducing the Founder Commitment Contribution to **US\$119**.

Please Note: Applications are reviewed on a rolling basis. Need-based support is limited, offered on a first-come, first-served basis, and will close once all available slots have been allocated, regardless of the deadline.

Application Process

Applications are reviewed on a rolling basis.

To apply:

Please read through the program's brochure and the FAQ section to better understand the program details

Complete the online application form at pipeline.amstevehouse.com.

Submit a pitch deck, business plan, or other supporting material.

Optional: Submit a short founder video.

Request need-based fee support if applicable.

Successful applicants will receive admission instructions and onboarding details.

Frequently Asked Questions

Program & Eligibility

How long does the program last?

The Venture Readiness Clinic lasts between 2 and 4 weeks depending on the selected track.

The Fundraising Accelerator lasts approximately 12 weeks.

Including the transition period between both stages, participants should expect a total experience of approximately 18 weeks.

What are the current program dates?

The current proposed schedule runs from July 31, 2026 through December 4, 2026.

Dates may be adjusted based on operational considerations and participant needs.

Is the program only for startups already raising capital?

No.

The program is suitable for founders planning a future raise as well as those actively fundraising.

Can venture-backed startups apply?

Absolutely.

Previously funded startups who already received at least \$20k in equity funding from venture capital can be exempted from the Venture Readiness Clinic.

What is the InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™ and Venture Backability Report?

The **InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™ (IVBA)** is an independent, expert-led assessment designed to help founders understand how investor-ready their ventures are and identify the areas that matter most for improvement.

The IVBA offers three different prepositions that are complementary to each other:

Diagnostic tool – helping founders identify weaknesses and improve their ventures.

Investor-facing credential – a standardized report that founders can share with investors.

Deal-flow infrastructure – a dynamic assessment that accumulates market signals and potentially reduces investor diligence costs.

The assessment evaluates factors such as your team, market opportunity, product, traction, financial readiness, and fundraising preparedness. The findings are compiled into your sharable **InvestoVilla Venture Backability Report™ (IVBR)**.

The IVBR is more than a diagnostic tool. It provides founders with a structured, investor-facing summary of their venture's strengths, risks, and areas for development. Founders can use the report to strengthen their businesses, guide fundraising preparation, and support conversations with potential investors and funding partners.

Unlike a static report, the IVBR is designed to evolve. As founders address identified gaps and make progress throughout their fundraising journey, they may request for update in their assessment to reflect improvements in their venture's readiness.

Over time, founders may also request and incorporate relevant signals (feedback) from investor engagements, creating a better shared investors intelligence and richer picture of how the market perceives the opportunity.

The goal is simple: to help founders become more investable while making it easier for investors to understand and evaluate promising ventures through structured and credible information.

What happens after the program?

The end of the InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program is intended to mark the beginning of a longer-term relationship with the InvestoVilla ecosystem rather than the end of the journey.

Participants who successfully complete the program may be invited to join the broader InvestoVilla founder community, where they can continue to access selected opportunities, ecosystem engagements, and relevant updates.

In addition, top-performing participants may be considered for participation in other InvestoVilla initiatives and allied programs, including the **InvestoVilla Funds Platform Program** and the **InvestoVilla Syndicate Program**, where applicable.

From time to time, eligible ventures may also be considered for other opportunities that arise within the ecosystem, including targeted capital calls, curated investor introductions, investor showcases, strategic partnerships, and other forms of support aligned with their stage of growth and fundraising objectives.

Participation in the program does not guarantee investment, investor introductions, admission into any other InvestoVilla initiative, or access to specific funding opportunities. Such opportunities are extended at the discretion of the InvestoVilla team and are subject to venture readiness, strategic fit, availability, and the requirements of participating investors and partners.

Fees & Financial Support

Is the program free?

The Fundraising Accelerator is delivered at no cost.

Founders participating in the Venture Readiness Clinic before entering the accelerator, are required to pay a Founder Commitment Contribution fee of \$299

What Does the Founder Commitment Contribution Fee Cover

The fee covers the Venture Readiness Assessment fee which is a signature and independent offering by InvestoVilla and typically priced at \$499. For this program, the standard subsidized pilot fee is \$299.

Is financial support available?

Yes.

Founders who apply and onboard well ahead of June 30, 2026 may request need-based fee reduction support.

Approved applicants may participate for as little as \$119. This is only available on first come, first serve basis until all the available slots are filled.

Why is there a fee for the Venture Readiness Clinic?

The Fundraising Accelerator is delivered entirely free of charge because we believe founders should not have to give up equity or pay significant fees simply to access fundraising support.

The Venture Readiness Clinic is different.

It includes structured diagnostics, venture reviews, consulting support, personalized feedback, and the InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™—our proprietary venture readiness assessment designed to help founders understand how investors are likely to evaluate their businesses.

The clinic fee serves two purposes.

First, it helps cover part of the cost of delivering these assessments and consulting activities.

Second, it acts as a commitment filter. Fundraising is demanding, and experience has shown that founders who invest time, energy, and resources into preparation are more likely to engage fully with the process. This helps us maintain a high-quality founder community and a stronger pipeline for investors.

For the pilot cohort, the clinic is heavily subsidized.

Founders accepted through the need-based support program may participate for as little as **\$119**. At this rate, the fee only covers the cost of the InvestoVilla Venture Backability Assessment™ in part, while the additional consulting, mentorship, diagnostics, and support provided during the clinic are effectively subsidized by the program.

Previously venture-backed startups may be eligible for exemption from parts or all of the Venture Readiness Clinic where prior funding history already provides sufficient validation of venture readiness.

Is need-based support guaranteed?

No.

Support is limited and awarded on a rolling basis.

Availability may close before June 30 once allocated slots are filled. Applicants wishing to apply for fee reduction are advised to apply well ahead of the introductory deadline of June 30, 2026

Fundraising & Investment

Why is the program focused on founders raising between US\$20,000 and US\$1 million?

We have intentionally focused the program on founders raising between US\$20,000 and US\$1 million because this is the range where most of our allied investors, funding partners, syndicates, and capital providers are actively deploying capital.

As a pipeline development program, our goal is not simply to help founders become investment-ready. We also want to increase the likelihood that investor-ready founders are building within funding ranges that can be matched to real opportunities in the market.

By concentrating on this segment, we are able to provide more relevant fundraising support, stronger investor alignment, and better potential pathways to capital for participants who successfully progress through the program.

That said, fundraising needs vary. Founders raising outside this range are still welcome to apply, particularly where there is a strong fit with the objectives of the program or a complementary fundraising strategy already in place.

Is there a guarantee I will raise funding?

No.

No credible organization can guarantee fundraising outcomes.

Our role is to help founders improve readiness, strengthen strategy, avoid mistakes, and engage investors more effectively.

Actual fundraising outcomes depend on many factors, including venture quality, execution, market conditions, and founder commitment.

Will InvestoVilla invest directly in my startup?

No.

This program is designed to prepare founders for investment.

However, strong-performing startups may receive introductions to investors, syndicates, partner funds, or future InvestoVilla initiatives.

What happens if I raise funding during the program?

Congratulations.

We will continue supporting you through investor discussions, due diligence processes, negotiation preparation, and post-investment planning where appropriate.

Is progression from the Venture Readiness Clinic to the Accelerator automatic?

No.

Participants are expected to meet minimum performance, engagement, and readiness standards before progressing to the Accelerator.

This helps maintain the quality of the founder pipeline and ensures a valuable experience for all participants.

That said, progression is not designed to be a barrier. Founders who actively participate, complete required assignments, demonstrate coachability, and show meaningful progress throughout the Clinic are highly likely to advance.

We are less concerned with where you start and more interested in how far you are willing to go. Some founders enter the program with stronger credentials or more experience, but commitment, execution, and willingness to learn often matter far more than where you begin.

A founder who consistently engages with the program, completes required tasks to a satisfactory standard, and applies the feedback received will generally be well-positioned to progress to the Accelerator.

Do you take equity for participation in the program?

No.

InvestoVilla does not take equity as a condition of participating in the InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program for Entrepreneurs (IPDPE). Any funding you raise during or after the program remains subject solely to the terms agreed between you and your investors.

Participation in IPDPE does not grant InvestoVilla any ownership interest in your company, nor does it create any obligation for you to participate in any other InvestoVilla program.

From time to time, participants may be invited to explore other InvestoVilla initiatives, including the InvestoVilla Syndicate Program or Funds Platform. These are separate programs with their own eligibility criteria, terms, and conditions, which may include investment or equity-related arrangements where applicable.

Participation in IPDPE neither requires participation in these programs nor guarantees admission into them.

Do I retain ownership of my intellectual property (IP) and business materials?

Yes.

You retain full ownership of your intellectual property, business ideas, products, technologies, trademarks, data, pitch materials, and other proprietary information shared as part of your participation in the program.

Participation in IPDPE does not transfer any ownership rights to InvestoVilla, AM-Steve House, mentors, investors, or other participants.

InvestoVilla may review information you voluntarily provide for purposes related to program delivery, assessment, mentorship, investor readiness, and potential introductions. However, all intellectual property remains the property of the founder or venture owner unless otherwise agreed in writing.

Any future participation in separate InvestoVilla programs will be governed by their respective terms and conditions and will not affect your ownership rights under IPDPE.

Will information about my startup be shared with investors?

Only with your consent.

A core objective of IPDPE is to help founders become more investor-ready and, where appropriate, facilitate introductions to relevant investors and funding opportunities. However, participation in the program does not entitle participants to investor introductions, deal referrals, or inclusion in any InvestoVilla syndicate, Funds Platform, or allied investment opportunity. Such opportunities may be offered at InvestoVilla's discretion to eligible participants based on readiness, fit, performance, and other relevant considerations.

InvestoVilla will not intentionally share confidential business information with third parties without your permission, except where required by law or as otherwise agreed by you.

Founders remain responsible for determining what information they choose to disclose to investors during fundraising discussions.

Participation & Policies

What if I cannot follow the cohort timeline?

Contact the program team.

In some situations, alternative arrangements may be possible but cannot guaranteed.

How much one-on-one support will I receive?

Accepted participants should expect up to two one-on-one consulting or advisory sessions per month during the Accelerator phase, in addition to group coaching, peer learning, reviews, and other program activities.

We encourage founders to use these sessions strategically and focus on the decisions, challenges, and opportunities that matter most to their fundraising journey.

Where additional support is required beyond the standard allocation, participants may request extra advisory sessions, subject to availability and applicable consulting rates.

Will participants be monitored?

We do not micromanage founders.

However, participation standards apply and non-performing participants may be removed from the program.

What is the refund policy?

Due to the limited and subsidized nature of the need-based support category, participants admitted under the need-based fee reduction category are not eligible for refunds.

Participants paying the standard subsidized clinic fee may request:

- **100%** refund up to **four (4)** weeks before program start
- **60%** refund up to **two (2)** weeks before program start

No refunds are available after the clinic begins.

INVESTOVILLA PIPELINE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAM FOR ENTREPRENEURS
TERMS AND CONDITION

Meet the Program Lead



The InvestoVilla Pipeline Development Program is led by [Dr. Ugwumsinachi Okorie](#), venture builder, investor-readiness advisor, and Managing Partner at [AM-Steve House](#).

Over the past 18 years, Dr. Okorie has worked across entrepreneurship, venture development, finance, technology, education, agriculture, and sustainability, supporting founders, enterprises, and ecosystem initiatives across Africa and internationally.

At AM-Steve House, he leads several flagship initiatives including the AM-Steve House Sustainability Program in Agriculture and Renewable Energy, the Women in Digital Business Program implemented in partnership with the International Training Centre of the International Labour Organization (ITCILO), and the group's One Venture Fund initiative. He also developed the Twin Venture Model, a framework designed to improve innovation distribution and venture accessibility for underserved markets in Africa.

Beyond [AM-Steve House](#), Dr. Okorie has held venture-building and capital market leadership roles, including serving as Entrepreneur-in-Residence at Seedstars and Director of Origination, Global Capital Markets at East Century Capital, Hong Kong. He is also involved with venture finance platforms in the United States, supporting deal sourcing, ecosystem development, and investment-readiness initiatives.

His experience spans both sides of the table: working with founders building ventures and engaging with investors evaluating opportunities.

Dr. Okorie has served as a judge, reviewer, mentor, or advisor for some of the world's leading entrepreneurship and innovation initiatives, including MIT Solve, Africa's Business Heroes, the Royal Academy of Engineering, Wharton-QS Reimagine Education Awards, the Diamond Challenge (Horn Entrepreneurship by the University of Delaware), the Tony Elumelu Foundation Entrepreneurship Programme, the World Resources Institute Land Accelerator, UNIDO's Global Cleantech Innovation Programme, and the Impact!Africa Mentorship Programme delivered by Ashoka and the British Council, among others.

As Managing Partner of [AM-Steve House](#), he also served as National Training Partner for Nigeria under the €120 million West Africa Competitiveness Programme (WACOMP), an ECOWAS initiative implemented by UNIDO and GIZ. He further represented AM-Steve House as one of the four organizations that served on the Financial Inclusion Cluster of the African Union's US\$100 billion Women and Youth Financial and Economic Inclusion (WYFEI2030) Initiative alongside institutions such as Ecobank, CARE International, and RE Entrepreneurs.

He has received numerous professional laurels for his work including Distinguished Fellowship of the African Institute of Public Administration (AIPA-Ghana) and Fellowship of the Institute of Management Consultants (IMC-Nigeria). He was appointed a Young Global Business Leader of the Economy of Francesco under the papacy of Pope Francis, and was a 2024–25 ELTI Leadership and Impact Scholar at the Yale School of the Environment.

Through InvestoVilla, his focus is simple: helping founders build ventures that are genuinely investable, engage investors more effectively, and raise capital with greater clarity, confidence, and strategic intent.

Application Questions

Instruction: Please answer in your own words rather than excessive use of AI in drafting your responses. We are more interested in understanding your venture, thinking, and fundraising challenges than in how polished your writing is. Brief and honest responses are preferred.

Selection Questions

Tell us about your venture. What problem are you solving, who are you serving, and what makes your solution different? (200–300 words)

Links to Founder Profile and Social Media Presence e.g. LinkedIn, Facebook or X

Link to Your Pitch Deck, Business Plan or any Other Supporting Document – share link to at least one document

Link to Your Video Presentation, Product Demo, etc. (optional)

Commitment Question

Why is now the right time for you to join this program? (150 words)

NB: this question has been added to assess your urgency, seriousness, coachability, and commitment

Training Needs Questions

- A. What is the biggest challenge you face—or expect to face—in raising capital? (100 words)
- B. If you could receive any support to address those challenges, what would be most valuable to you? We want to understand what you think may be the solutions to your challenges (100 words)
- C. What would success look like for you at the end of this program? (150 words)

Fundraising Question

- D. What type of funding are you seeking?

Select all that apply:

Grants
Equity Investment
Venture Debt
Revenue-Based Financing
Convertible Note/SAFE
Crowdfunding
Strategic Partnerships
Not Yet Sure

- E. How much capital are you currently raising or planning to raise?

- ❖ Less than \$20,000
- ❖ \$20,000–\$50,000
- ❖ \$50,001–\$100,000
- ❖ \$100,001–\$250,000
- ❖ \$250,001–\$500,000
- ❖ \$500,001–\$1M
- ❖ Others (please specify)

- F. Have you raised external funding before? (Y/N)
- G. If Yes, Provide Details – include name of financier, size, date and name and current status of the venture raised for, if different your current venture (200 words)
- H. What best describes your current fundraising status?

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- We are currently closing an investment round (due diligence, legal, or negotiations underway)
 - We have received investor interest or commitments but have not yet closed
 - We are actively fundraising and engaging investors
 - We are preparing to start fundraising
 - We plan to raise in the future but have not started preparations
 - We are still validating or building the venture
 - We paused a previous fundraising effort
 - Other, please specify

I. Have you already engaged any financier/investor or their intermediaries (Y/N)

J. If yes, provide very specific details – Please provide specific details including investor/funder name, organization, and current status of the discussion (200 words).